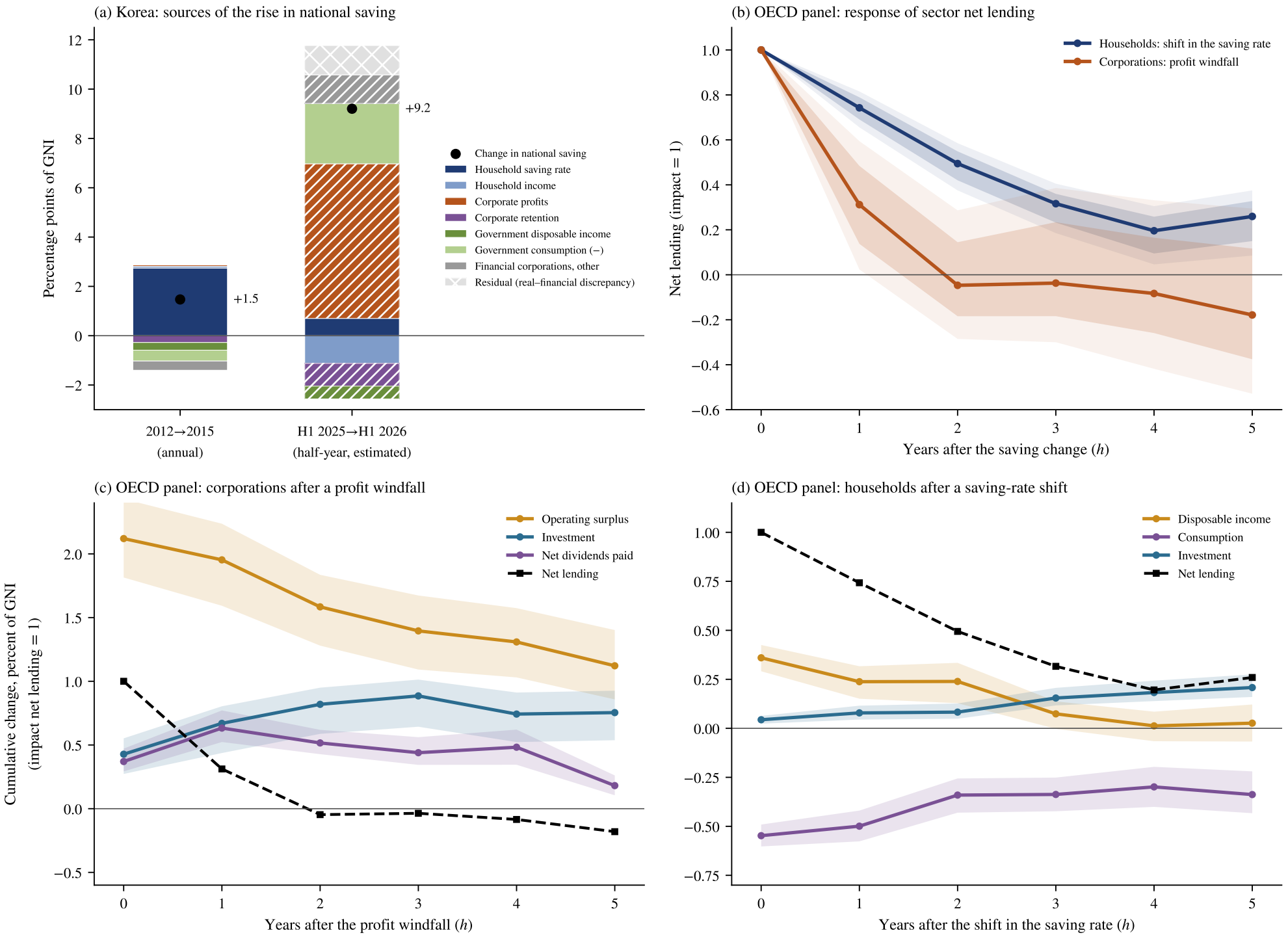
Korea's saving surge then and now, and how each kind of saving fades



Notes: (a) Gross saving, percent of GNI. Corporate saving splits into a profit component (change in operating surplus at the earlier retention ratio) and a retention component; household saving into a saving-rate and an income component; government saving into disposable income and minus final consumption. 2012→2015: OECD annual sector accounts, cumulated over the years. H1 2026: Bank of Korea quarterly accounts; hatched components are estimated (sector saving = investment + flow-of-funds net lending + the gap between the two accounts at its H1 2025 share of GNI; households: published saving); the unattributed widening of that gap is a residual. (b)–(d) Annual data for 38 economies, 1973–2025 (unbalanced). Local projections with lags of own net lending, both saving components, GDP growth and government net lending, and country and year fixed effects; normalized by the impact response of net lending. (b) 68 and 90 percent bands, country-cluster bootstrap (999 replications). (c)–(d) Cumulative changes from year −1 in items of each sector's account, percent of GNI, scaled by the impact response of the sector's net lending; shaded: 68 percent bands. Corporate taxes and interest, small, are not shown. Sources: OECD; Bank of Korea; authors' calculations.